Silverheights School Council Meeting Minutes

Date & Time: Sep 24, 2025 - 6:30 to 8:30 - library

Meeting #1 - In Person Only

> *"Parents play a vital role in the development and education of their children and in the success of schools. They are the most important influence in a child's life outside of school.*
> *Long after direct learning from parents in a child's early years gives way to formal education, parents continue to play a key role in student success through the attitudes they help to share and the direct supports they provide."*
>
> Ontario Ministry of Education

School Council Summary: https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/school-councils/

School Council Handbook: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/school_council_chairpersons_handbook.pdf

A school council is an advisory body that functions within the parameters of Ministry of Education and Board policy. School councils provide an opportunity and the means to advise the principal and the Board on any matter pertaining to improvement of pupil achievement and enhancing the accountability of the education system to parents/guardians. The ultimate responsibility for the administration and management of the day-to-day operation of the school rests with the principal.

Item	Agenda Item	Duration	Person(s) Responsible
1	**Welcome** Present: Andrea Schofield, Jenna Northover, Heather Train, Lindsay Paetkau, Darpana Sanghvi, Jason Stere, Alison Chong, Caroline Rainville, Shaun McCracken, Ling Tam, Kate Davy, Tara Goudy Regrets: Michelle Thompson, Leah McCreight, Amy Lucas Sandra Broocks, Alison McGauley, Alissa Fraser, Elise Gammie, Kristen Medencevic, Kristen Yinger, Ariel Buchan, Erin Ambachstheer, Ruby Hansmann, Ramya Venugopal, Emily Cooper, Navdeep Kaur, Sunny Sharma, Tammy Nguyen, Supriya Anand, Amanda Elliott, Christina Galway, Sara Khlat	1 mins	Co-Chair
2	**Territorial Acknowledgement & Equity Connection** -	2 mins	Vice Principal (T. Goudy)
3	**Council Housekeeping** - Nominations for positions - Google Form - Voting - Co-Chairs - Ling Tam & Alison Chong Jones - Secretary - no secretary at this time - Treasurer - Shaun McCracken - WRAPSC Rep - no rep at this time - Pizza Subcommittee members - Chair - Kate Davy - Secretary - Heather Train - Volunteer Coordinator - Shaun McCracken - Pizza Procurement Specialist - Darpana Sanghvi	5 mins	Co-Chair (L.Tam)
4	**News**		

	Community Partnership – Silverheights Neighbourhood Association - **Update** www.silverheightsneighnourhood.com - For more information, please email programs@silverheightsneighbourhood.com - All fall programs are on their website - Check out their social media	5 mins	SNA Representative
	WRAPC/PIC https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/ - WRAPSC Minutes	5 mins	WRAPSC Rep
	Teacher Update - Calm start to the new school year - Terry Fox run postponed to Friday due to weather - Intermediate Athletic Council - students have applied for roles - Intermediate boys football & girls soccer underway - Creative playground temporarily closed for repairs; planned reopening portion of creative on Monday pending inspection. Repair work order on cordoned section has been submitted, expect timeline for repairs to be lengthy requiring Board inspection and approvals. - Library is open with librarian (Mrs. K) - Oral Reading Fluency and Acadiance literacy is underway - New technology for administering IEP, plans, student profiles; navigating technology is a challenge and learning curve - Extracurricular clubs (Tyler Siroky will run D&D and Band) have not yet started; soliciting teacher volunteers - GSA hopefully continuing with teachers and community members - 3 extracurricular club proposals currently being reviewed by school admin, if clubs identify funding needs, proposals to School Council would be considered.	10 mins	Teacher Rep (A. Schofield)
5	**Principal's Report** - Enrolment update ~700+ students representing influx of late summer registrants. - Late registrations puts pressure on school admin and class sizes. - Reach maximum capacity in kindergarten and junior classrooms (capacity currently at 27 to 29 per class, max is 30) - Intermediate classes are reasonable sizes this year (23 or 24 per class). - Split grade classrooms are dictated by the Board and Province; there is 1 less split grade classroom this year compared to last. School admin recognizes split grades are challenging to navigate for students and staff. - Umbrella project has resumed; themes change every year (umbrella project website) - Umbrella Project Monthly topics: - October-Empathy - November- Growth Mindset - December-Intrinsic- Kindness - January- Authenticity - February-Self-efficacy - March-Purpose - April-Cognitive Flexibility	10 mins	Principal (J. Stere)

	- May- Realistic Optimism - June- Healthy Living - Silverheights PS piloted an anonymous bullying reporting tool. Instructions for use shared from the Board was not prescriptive and few community reports were submitted by Silverheights PS, representing one of the lowest rates of incidents and the absolute lowest by percentage of population. School admin attributes this to consistent character education and by holding kids accountable and to ensure they develop from a learning perspective. School admin recognizes (the low rate) does not mean there is not bullying but they try hard to bring awareness to it. Silverheights Bullying Prevention & Intervention Website This link is a tool where you report an element of bullying if you are a student, caregiver, teacher etc. - Continued focus areas from school improvement perspective we will continue with literacy and inclusivity, culture creed and neurodiversity - School admin has asked teachers to create a learning goal and create a plan for themselves which will directly affect the students learning and wellbeing - Safety drills at the school include firedrills, extreme weather (e.g. tornado) drills, and lockdown (hold and secure). Ongoing learnings from consecutive firedrills (total of three thus far). Latest fire drill was perfectly executed. PA system broadcasts these drills to the school exterior so community members who overhear these drills should not be alarmed or get involved in any way. Established policies and procedures by the Ministry and Board in the event of actual incidences are at this link: Administrative Procedure 1360 - Lots of school transportation (bussing) issues to start the year. The school does not have control over these issues; it is run by Board-approved transportation company. The Board is doing what they can to sort this out. - Acknowledgement to 2024-2025 School Council for taking the initiative as caregivers to advocate for additional traffic calming and control measures for the safety of our walking students. Specifically, a crossing guard is now posted at Sasha/Poplar to help students cross the road & this has helped the flow of walkers considerably - 2 City Bylaw blitzes have been completed since the beginning of the school year. 36 tickets given on the third day of school. - Per Ministry mandate related to protection of daycare facilities from vehicular incidence, safety pylons have been placed in the parking lot of the licensed daycare area. These are a temporary measure until the Ministry provides specific guidance and funding for permanent solutions.		
6	**New Agenda Items** - Fundraising goals for School Council to support transportation costs for field trips - School Admin shared that transportation costs have increased significantly (50% increase) compared to previously ears - Council discussed alternate ways to support curricular learning for each student - Any ideas or opportunities must be submitted to School Admin and vetted through the Board - Establish Breaking Barriers equity fund - $1000 - Community awareness and vigilance - stolen vehicle contents dumped at bus stop by swings on Apple Dr. - call non emergency number if any suspicious behaviour or dumped items from stolen car - Guest speakers	5 mins	Council

	- If a guest speaker is being considered, topics must be aligned with curriculum & teachers provide rationale that includes a long term plan to achieve learning objectives throughout the school year		
7	**Financial Report** - Treasurer Report - See Below o Direct cost of pizza has increased by the vendor; Pizza subcommittee has proposed to increase cost per slice from $2.00 to $2.25. o $32,000 was raised last year from pizza sales o Estimated funds for this current school year is $XX,XXX o Based on current affordability crisis, Council acknowledges no additional fundraising campaigns will be organized this year with the exception of: ▪ Dominoes pizza codes to run for a limited time ▪ Extracurricular club fundraisers to be executed by students, with support from School Council. List of potential fundraising partners can be made available to the clubs upon request.	10 min	Treasurer (S. McCracken)
8	**Subcommittees** **1) Pizza Subcommittee - Chair - K. Davey, Volunteer Co-ordinator- S. McCracken, Procurement Specialists- D. Sanghvi, Secretary- H. Train** o Pizza Days starting on September 30th o Pizza pricing has increased to $2.25 due to vendor costs ▪ Pizza subcommittee members for 2025/2026 (many returning from previous years) ● Caroline Rainville, Alison Chong, Kate Davy, Heather Train, Lindsay Paetkau, Darpana Sanghvi ▪ Emails are volunteers (google groups) **2) Activity Fair Subcommittee - Co-Chairs & Co- Secretaries - C. Rainville, and A. McCracken** o Council has voted not to form a subcommittee this year o List of camp offerings should be sent out via School Day earlier this year to facilitate sign-ups o Caroline Rainville will revisit the camp list to confirm organization offerings & contact information. o Names of community organizations running camps should be shared with Caroline to be added to the list.	15 mins	Chair (A. Jones)
9	**Questions & Answer Period**	5 mins	Council Members
10	**Next Meeting Date:** Oct 22, 2025 6:30 to 8:30 in library		In-person
11	**Agenda Items for Next Meeting** The mission of the School Council is to work to ensure the highest academic achievement and personal development of all of our Silverheights students. Please complete google form: Agenda Item Request for School Council	1 min	Chair (A. Jones)
12	Adjournment		

Notes:

MOE – Ontario Ministry of Education

PIC – Parent Involvement Committee (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/)

PRO – Parents Reaching Out

SCIS – Safe, Caring & Inclusive Schools (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/links/safe-caring-and-inclusive-schools-scis-resources/)

WRAPSC – Waterloo Region Assembly of Public School Councils (https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/)

General Council Email: silverheightscouncil@gmail.com